University of Trier
Software Engineering Group
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Information Visualization
Summer Semester 2026
Exercise Sheet 1

Group work: Please keep in mind that the exercises are meant to prepare you for the exam.
ChatBots: Use your own brain as much and as often as possible.

Exercise 1 (Visualization Zoo)

Carefully read the provided article *"A Tour Through the Visualization Zoo"* (PDF available in Stud.IP), then finish the following tasks:

1. Create a detailed mind map that summarizes the content of the article. Make sure that another person can understand the mind map without having read the text. The mind map should cover all important aspects mentioned in the article. In particular, it should structure the described visualizations, enabling readers to compare them. To create the mind map you may use, for instance, the *Freeplane* application or the online tool *coggle*.
2. The authors of the article mention that all visualizations are based on a mapping between certain properties of the data and visual attributes such as position, size, shape, and color. Describe the mapping of those four attributes for the visualizations depicted in Figures 2d, 3b, 4f, and 5c in a table that allows comparison of the individual mappings.